substantial aid of fifty thousand tonnes of rice and fifteen million metres of cloth. Even Saudi Arabia granted Bangladesh recognition immediately after the coup, which it had not done in the four years of Mujib's rule. The Indian government initially feared the involvement of pro-Maoist elements which had long been anti-Mujib. It is not known whether China had had a hand in the coup but the country welcomed the change, which was interpreted as a development favourable to its policy of promoting strife and tension in the subcontinent. Unlike other missions in Dhaka, the Indian embassy was cut off from the rest of the world for almost forty-eight hours. The telephone connections of the Indian High Commission, other offices and the official residence were neutralised just around the time of the coup.

An Indian government note said: 'The Bangladesh Ambassador in Kuwait Gen. Wasi-uddin appears to be involved in the coup. He was the senior most Bengali officer in the Pakistan army and was known to be bitter about having been denied his dues. We may also hear more of Brigadier Rauf formerly the Director of Forces Intelligence, who returned from London on 13 August 1975, when the Army finally revealed its hands. Bangladesh appears to be in for a period of unrest and instability with frequent changes of men and policies.'

What shocked the Indian government even more was President Khondaker Mostaq Ahmad's radio broadcast of 16 August. Ahmad did not name India in the broadcast but hinted that a 'particular power' allowed corruption, nepotism and political manipulations during Mujib's regime. Mostaq, who had appointed Major General Ziaur Rahman as army chief, went on to announce the keenness of his government to cultivate close and friendly ties with the Islamic countries, the big powers of